You may be familiar with NASA's *Cassini* spacecraft (Figure 7.7). It was launched from Earth on October 15, 1997, with too little fuel to reach its destination, Saturn. The deficit was dealt with by slingshots: around Venus on April 26, 1998; a second slingshot around Venus on July 24, 1999; around Earth on August 18, 1999; and around Jupiter on December 30, 2000. Arriving at Saturn on July 1, 2004, *Cassini* slowed down with the aid of a slingshot around Saturn's closest moon, Io.

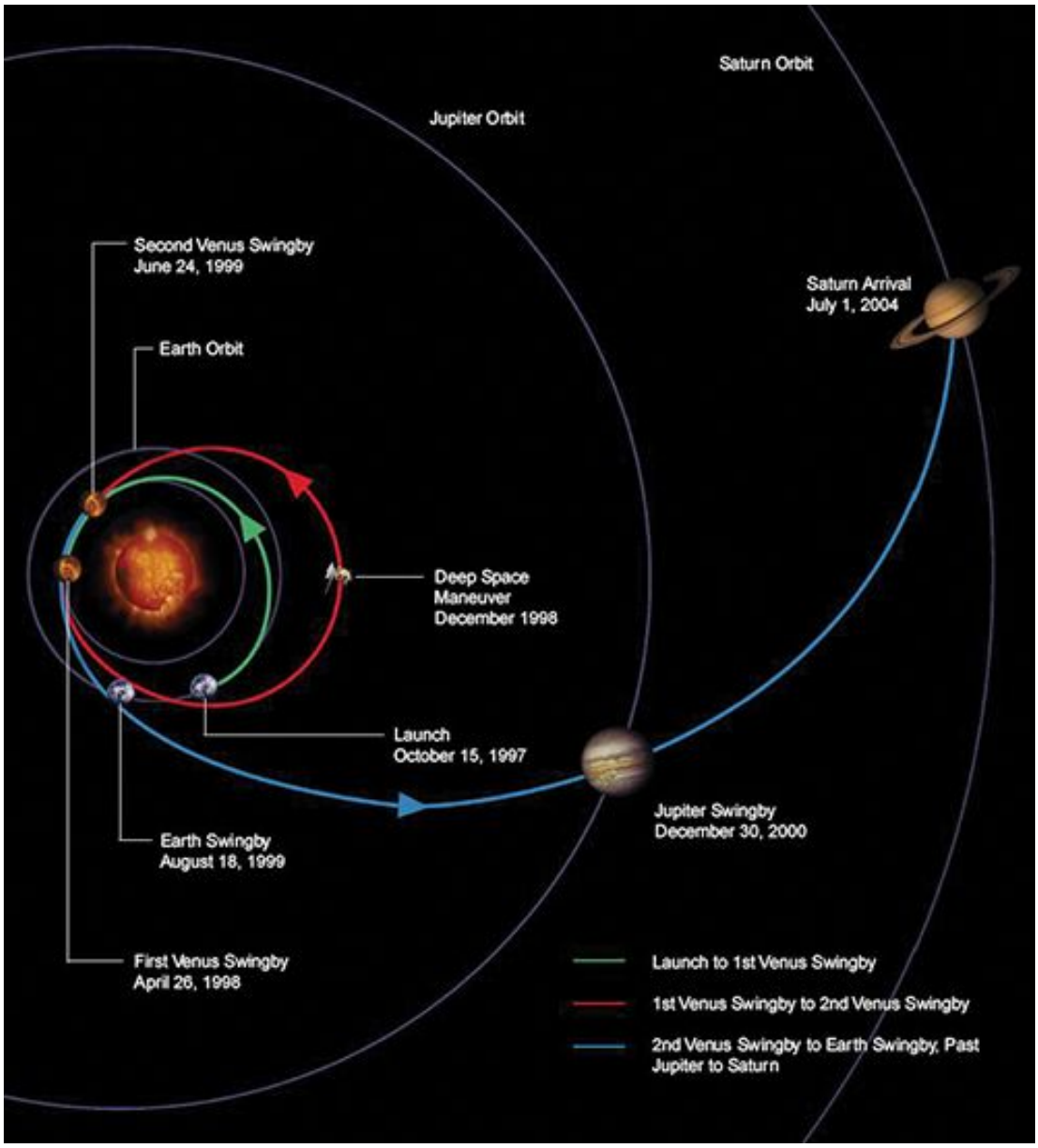


Fig. 7.7. The trajectory of *Cassini* from Earth to Saturn.